

Most importantly, however, you need to remember that in India, the majority are on dial-up, and will not be patient enough to wait for your menus to load, or for a Flash intro to complete.

Even if you feel that your site is not complete without a Flash intro, make sure to prominently display a 'Skip Intro' option, for visitors who do not want to wait for the intro to finish loading. Also, if you just have to use Flash menus, make sure the same menu instance is used throughout your site, so that browsers will be able to cache the item and not reload it for every page.

Gaudy Colours

Some Web sites give you the idea that the people who designed them are colour-blind! You will come across many sites that are likely to drive you mad, or make you blind, if you spend too much time on them. This is mainly due to a very bad sense of colour matching. There isn't much to explain here—with millions of colour combinations available, it's purely up to you to decide what combinations are just not right.

Browser Support

Most designers don't seem to care about whether their sites work on browsers other than Internet Explorer (IE). In fact, it's not just site design you should worry about, you should also choose a hosting solution that is compatible with most browsers. For example, Microsoft's ASP technology is largely targeted at IE, and browsers such as Opera and Mozilla Firefox often run into trouble with some ASP pages.

The best way to check the functionality of your site is to check it using the most popular browsers. We suggest you start with Lynx, the popular text-based browser in Linux, to see what your site will most probably look like to a search engine bot, and then work your way through IE, Mozilla Firefox, Opera, and others.

Balanced Content

Sites with only text, or even those with only graphics, can be very